SMARTSPEND

SmartSpend Survey Questionnaire

For Content Validation

SmartSpend: An AI-Assisted Mobile Financial Tracking and Advisory Application

Lorma Colleges — College of Computer Studies and Engineering

This questionnaire contains 30 items across five sections. It is submitted to the adviser for content validation and signature prior to administration to the target respondents (parents and young professionals in San Fernando City, La Union).

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Section A — Respondent Profile (Q1–Q7)

Q1. What is your age?

- ☐ 21–25
- ☐ 26–30
- ☐ 31–34
- ☐ 35–40
- ☐ 41–45
- ☐ 46–50
- ☐ 51–55
- ☐ Below 21 / Above 55 (not eligible for this study)

Q2. Which category best describes you?

- ☐ Parent
- ☐ Young professional
- ☐ Both a parent and a young professional
- ☐ Neither

Q3. Do you currently reside in San Fernando City, La Union?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

Q4. What is your current employment status?

- ☐ Employed full-time
- ☐ Employed part-time
- ☐ Self-employed / business owner
- ☐ Freelance / contractual
- ☐ Government employee
- ☐ Unemployed
- ☐ Other

Q5. How many people, including yourself, depend on your income or financial support?

- ☐ None
- ☐ 1
- ☐ 2–3
- ☐ 4–5
- ☐ 6 or more

Q6. Who usually makes financial decisions in your household or personal life?

- ☐ I make the decisions independently
- ☐ I share decisions with my spouse or partner
- ☐ I share decisions with parents or other family members
- ☐ Someone else primarily makes the decisions
- ☐ Other

Q7. How often do you receive income?

- ☐ Weekly
- ☐ Every two weeks
- ☐ Twice a month
- ☐ Monthly
- ☐ Irregularly
- ☐ Other

Section B — Existing Financial Management Practices (Q8–Q13)

Objective 1, theme 1: how respondents plan, save and manage money today.

Q8. Do you prepare a budget for your personal or household finances?

- ☐ Always
- ☐ Often
- ☐ Sometimes
- ☐ Rarely
- ☐ Never

Q9. How do you usually manage your budget? (Select all that apply.)

- ☐ Written budget in a notebook
- ☐ Spreadsheet (e.g., Excel or Google Sheets)
- ☐ Mobile application
- ☐ Notes application on my phone
- ☐ Calculator
- ☐ Mental estimates or memory
- ☐ Advice or assistance from another person
- ☐ Other

Q10. How often do you review your financial situation?

- ☐ Daily
- ☐ Weekly
- ☐ Every two weeks
- ☐ Monthly
- ☐ Only when necessary
- ☐ Never

Q11. Do you set aside money for savings before spending on other expenses?

- ☐ Always
- ☐ Often
- ☐ Sometimes
- ☐ Rarely
- ☐ Never

Q12. How do you manage unexpected expenses?

- ☐ Use an emergency fund
- ☐ Use money allocated for other expenses
- ☐ Borrow money
- ☐ Use credit cards or other credit facilities
- ☐ Use additional income
- ☐ Ask family or friends for financial assistance
- ☐ Other

Q13. Do you usually know how much money remains available for spending before your next payday or income receipt?

- ☐ Always
- ☐ Often
- ☐ Sometimes
- ☐ Rarely
- ☐ Never

Section C — Common Budgeting Challenges (Q14–Q20)

Objective 1, theme 2: problems the system should help solve.

> For Questions 14–17: Rate on a 1–5 scale where 1 = Never, 2 = Rarely, 3 = Sometimes, 4 = Often, 5 = Always.

Q14. How often do your actual expenses exceed your planned budget?

- ☐ 1 = Never
- ☐ 2 = Rarely
- ☐ 3 = Sometimes
- ☐ 4 = Often
- ☐ 5 = Always

Q15. How often do you spend money on nonessential items that were not included in your budget?

- ☐ 1 = Never
- ☐ 2 = Rarely
- ☐ 3 = Sometimes
- ☐ 4 = Often
- ☐ 5 = Always

Q16. How often do you find it difficult to set aside money for savings after paying your expenses?

- ☐ 1 = Never
- ☐ 2 = Rarely
- ☐ 3 = Sometimes
- ☐ 4 = Often
- ☐ 5 = Always

Q17. How often do you have difficulty keeping track of bills, loan payments, or payment deadlines?

- ☐ 1 = Never
- ☐ 2 = Rarely
- ☐ 3 = Sometimes
- ☐ 4 = Often
- ☐ 5 = Always

Q18. What are the main challenges you experience when managing your finances? (Select all that apply.)

- ☐ Insufficient income
- ☐ Increasing prices of basic goods and services
- ☐ Unexpected medical or emergency expenses
- ☐ Family responsibilities or dependents
- ☐ Difficulty controlling discretionary spending
- ☐ Debt or loan repayments
- ☐ Irregular income
- ☐ Lack of a clear budget
- ☐ Difficulty recording expenses
- ☐ Difficulty tracking several financial obligations
- ☐ Lack of time to manage finances
- ☐ Lack of knowledge about budgeting
- ☐ I do not experience significant budgeting challenges
- ☐ Other

Q19. What do you usually do when you realize that you have exceeded your budget? (Select all that apply.)

- ☐ Reduce spending in other categories
- ☐ Use savings
- ☐ Delay nonessential purchases
- ☐ Borrow money
- ☐ Use credit
- ☐ Seek additional income
- ☐ Continue spending without adjusting the budget
- ☐ Other

Q20. What would help you manage your budget more effectively? (Select all that apply.)

- ☐ Automatic expense categorization
- ☐ Budget limits for each category
- ☐ Notifications when approaching a budget limit
- ☐ Bill and payment reminders
- ☐ Savings goal tracking
- ☐ Monthly financial summaries
- ☐ Spending trend reports
- ☐ Debt and loan tracking
- ☐ Financial education or budgeting tips
- ☐ Other

Section D — Expense Tracking Behaviors (Q21–Q26)

Objective 1, theme 3: how respondents record and monitor spending.

Q21. Do you currently record your personal or household expenses?

- ☐ Always
- ☐ Often
- ☐ Sometimes
- ☐ Rarely
- ☐ Never

Q22. How do you record your expenses? (Select all that apply.)

- ☐ Notebook or diary
- ☐ Spreadsheet
- ☐ Mobile financial management application
- ☐ Notes application
- ☐ Receipts
- ☐ Banking or e-wallet transaction history
- ☐ Mental estimates or memory
- ☐ I do not record expenses
- ☐ Other

Q23. How soon after making a purchase do you usually record the expense?

- ☐ Immediately
- ☐ Within the same day
- ☐ Within a few days
- ☐ At the end of the week
- ☐ At the end of the month
- ☐ I do not record expenses

Q24. Which expenses do you usually track? (Select all that apply.)

- ☐ Cash purchases
- ☐ Debit card transactions
- ☐ Credit card transactions
- ☐ Bank transfers
- ☐ E-wallet transactions
- ☐ Online purchases
- ☐ Recurring bills
- ☐ Loan repayments
- ☐ Savings contributions
- ☐ All of the above
- ☐ None of the above

Q25. How do you categorize your expenses?

- ☐ I use predefined categories
- ☐ I create my own categories
- ☐ I record expenses without categorizing them
- ☐ I estimate spending by category
- ☐ I do not track expenses

Q26. How often do you compare your actual spending with your planned budget?

- ☐ Daily
- ☐ Weekly
- ☐ Every two weeks
- ☐ Monthly
- ☐ Only when necessary
- ☐ Never

Section E — Supplementary Profile and Feature Needs (Q27–Q30)

Four questions added from the manuscript's Appendix B. Required for Table 3.1 respondent profile and for testing Warning Decay and AI feature adoption hypotheses.

Q27. What is your gender?

- ☐ Male
- ☐ Female
- ☐ Prefer not to say

Q28. What is your monthly income range?

- ☐ Below ₱10,000
- ☐ ₱10,000 – ₱20,000
- ☐ ₱20,000 – ₱40,000
- ☐ Above ₱40,000
- ☐ Prefer not to say / Not applicable

Q29. Have you ever exceeded your monthly budget and then continued spending without adjusting or ignoring a spending warning or alert?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ Not applicable (I do not have a budget)

Q30. Would you use an AI-powered financial assistant application to help manage your finances?

- ☐ Yes, definitely
- ☐ Probably yes
- ☐ Not sure
- ☐ Probably not
- ☐ No

CONTENT VALIDATOR CERTIFICATION

I hereby certify that I have reviewed the survey questionnaire and confirm that the questions are appropriate, valid, and suitable for administration to the target respondents.

Validator's Name: _____

Designation/Position: _____

Institution: _____

Signature: _____ **Date:** _____